BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #12 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

“If this treatment didn't work, nothing will.”

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Where it often comes from

After a treatment fails, hope takes a hit. Repeated disappointment trains us to expect failure and to stop trying. Fatigue and cost add to the temptation to quit.

What Scripture teaches

Peter and his friends had fished all night and caught nothing. Jesus said, “Put out into deep water, and let down your nets for a catch,” and Peter said, “Because You say so, I will let down the nets” (Luke 5:4–5). Scripture encourages persistence: “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9). One failed treatment does not mean all will fail, and God’s purposes are bigger than any plan.

> *“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up”* (Galatians 6:9).

Also see

> “When Jesus had finished speaking, He said to Simon, ‘Put out into deep water and let down your nets for a catch.’ ‘Master,’ Simon replied, ‘we have worked hard all night without catching anything. But because You say so, I will let down the nets.’” (Luke 5:4–5).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

> “But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint” (Isaiah 40:31).

> “Rest in God alone, O my soul, for my hope comes from Him” (Psalm 62:5).

Common self-statements

- It did not work, so nothing will.
- I am a hopeless case.
- Why try again?
- I am wasting time and money.
- There is nothing left.
- I am tired of being disappointed.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a treatment either works or nothing will.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that all options will fail.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling disappointed and concluding there is no hope.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself untreatable.

Challenging questions

- What exactly did not work, and what did we learn from it?
- What other options might exist?

- What does my doctor say about next steps?
- What encouraged me before?
- How do I care for my heart after disappointment?
- Who can support me through the next try?

Truth summary

> One failed treatment is one failed treatment. I can grieve the disappointment, ask my doctor about other options, and keep trusting God, who is with me whether or not the next step works.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Sickness
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If this treatment didn't work, nothing will"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If this treatment didn't work, nothing will." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly did not work, and what did we learn from it?
- ☐ What other options might exist?
- ☐ What does my doctor say about next steps?
- ☐ What encouraged me before?
- ☐ How do I care for my heart after disappointment?
- ☐ Who can support me through the next try?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Failure of one is not failure of all.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ I can ask my doctor about next steps.
- ☐ God is my hope.
- ☐ I do not despise small beginnings.
- ☐ God is with me either way.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:9
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ Luke 5:4–5
  "When Jesus had finished speaking, He said to Simon, 'Put out into deep water and let down your nets for a catch.' 'Master,' Simon replied, 'we have worked hard all night without catching anything. But because You say so, I will let down the nets.'"
- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Another step: Each week, note one step you took toward the next option.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "At the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Review with your doctor. Ask for other options.
- [ ] Seek a second opinion. Consider another specialist.
- [ ] Rest. Take time to recover from disappointment.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 62:5. Wait on God alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If this treatment didn't work, nothing will": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Another step
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If this treatment didn't work, nothing will.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am discouraged by treatment that did not work. Give me courage, wisdom about next steps, and hope in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.